

Magaly Gutierrez Initial 1 on 1

Situation 1: Starting With a New Team

When a manager joins a team, the first round of 1:1 meetings should be treated as discovery conversations. The goal is to understand how the team actually operates, what is working well and where problems exist.

These conversations help reveal the difference between the official process and the real one.

Understanding the Team

- What part of the team's work do you think is going especially well right now?
 - Retros, stand ups and parking lot items
 - Moved away from private messages into public channel
 - Connor is good at creating tickets
- If you could change one thing about how the team operates, what would it be?
- What part of our workflow feels harder than it should be?

Execution and Process

- Where do workstreams usually slow down?
- What tends to surprise us during projects?
- What types of work cause the most interruptions?

Leadership Expectations

- What do you think this team needs most from a manager?
- What did your previous manager do that worked well?
- What did you wish they had done differently?

Hidden Problems

- What issue do people complain about privately but not in meetings?
- What causes the most frustration on the team today?

These questions help the manager understand the real operating environment of the team.

Notes

- Still trying to learn

- Felt like the first month was getting it
- There is a buffer between customers and engineers
- Connor and Tim are trying to be the buffer
- What is urgent vs what isn't
 - Example: handling data foundation empty response error
 - Fixed the error and re-ran it
 - Still got messages in the DLQ
 - Turned out there was a different error
 - Did another fix
 - Realized there was about 7000 records that were impacted
 - DLQ is not clear
 - The DLQ was linked to the 7000 records
 - Now they were stuck in a different queue
 - Waiting to merge PR to see if it works
 - This morning she gets in and gets a message about 19 records
 - Tagged her and Connor
 - Asked to fast track them
 - Felt like it was urgent so she did the investigation
 - Wasn't grouped as described
 - There are a couple of other linked tickets but they don't seem to be there for the same reason.
- She made some suggestions on what we can do to do support
- The team helps each other, but with Vince being the only SME it is hard
 - Feels bad asking Vince for a lot of his time
- More feature work, less support
- Vince had gone over the code with her and Kevin which worked
 - It would be great to have some more time with Vince
- Trying to document as much as possible
 - Has some PRs to make logs better
 - Using Claude to help with that
 - Onboarding
-

About her

- NY
- Engineer for about 7 years
- Capital One for about 6 years
- Joined last year in April in Life Sciences
- Joined Payer in June 2026
- Mexico / Alabama
- Did school in Boston
- Got internship in NY

- What are our SLAs for support